

Financial Performance & Insights Dashboard

A Business Analysis Case Study
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Project Overview

This project involved designing an end-to-end financial performance dashboard for a business analysis case study. The goal was to translate raw financial data into a single-page executive dashboard that answers the ten most important business questions stakeholders ask about revenue, profit, expenses, regional and departmental performance, and budget discipline.

Business Objective

Leadership needed a clear, at-a-glance view of financial health that could support decision-making without requiring a deep dive into raw figures. The dashboard was designed to answer questions such as: How is the business performing overall? How does revenue trend across the year? How does actual spend compare to budget? Which regions and departments drive (or drag) performance? And what specific actions would improve profitability?

Key Performance Indicators

TOTAL REVENUE \$126.03M	TOTAL PROFIT \$115.93M	OPERATING EXPENSES \$12.73M	PROFIT MARGIN 91.98%	BUDGET VARIANCE \$113.31M Fav.
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Approach & Methodology

- Data consolidation:** Consolidated revenue, profit, expense, regional, and departmental data into a single analytical structure.
- Metric calculation:** Calculated core financial metrics — profit margin, budget variance, and cost-to-revenue ratios — to quantify efficiency.
- Dashboard design:** Designed a one-page dashboard layout structured around business questions, insights, and recommendations so it reads as a decision-support tool rather than a raw data dump.
- Visual storytelling:** Used icon-led KPI cards, trend and comparison visuals, and colour-coded sections (questions, insights, recommendations) to guide the reader through the story.
- Insight-to-action mapping:** Converted every insight into a specific, actionable recommendation tied to a business owner or department.

Key Insights

- Strong overall performance:** Revenue reached \$126.03M with \$115.93M in profit, producing an exceptional 91.98% profit margin — a sign of very efficient cost management.
- Seasonal trends:** Revenue and profit fluctuate through the year, peaking in March and October, with a noticeable dip in December.
- Favourable budget performance:** Actual revenue exceeded budget every month, producing a total favourable variance of \$113.31M.
- Regional contribution:** The North region contributes the most revenue at \$53M, while the South region contributes the least at \$17M.

- **Departmental profit:** HR generates the highest departmental profit (\$22M), followed by Marketing (\$19M) and Sales (\$17M), while Operations trails at \$13M.
- **Operating expenses:** Total operating expenses stand at \$12.73M, with HR, IT, Marketing, and Sales each accounting for roughly 14–15% of the total.
- **Profit vs. expenses:** Total profit is significantly higher than total operating expenses, confirming strong cost control and operational efficiency.

Recommendations

- **Sustain profitability drivers:** Identify and replicate the operational practices behind high-margin departments across the wider business.
- **Leverage revenue peaks:** Investigate what drives the March and October peaks and reapply those campaigns or seasonal initiatives elsewhere in the year.
- **Address the December dip:** Analyse the causes of the December dip and respond with targeted promotions, customer engagement, or end-of-year offers.
- **Balance regional investment:** Continue investing in the North region while building targeted growth strategies for lower-performing regions, especially the South.
- **Monitor departmental expenses:** Monitor spend in high-cost departments (HR, IT, Marketing, Sales) without constraining productivity or revenue generation.
- **Track and review regularly:** Set monthly and quarterly targets for revenue, profit, and expenses, and review performance against them regularly to sustain favourable variance.

Key Takeaway

The business is highly profitable, with excellent cost efficiency and a favourable budget position. By reinforcing what already works in top-performing regions and departments, addressing the December revenue dip, and supporting weaker regions with targeted strategies, the business can sustain growth and build long-term value for stakeholders.

Tools & Skills Demonstrated

- Business dashboard design and data storytelling
- Financial analysis: revenue, profit margin, budget variance, cost analysis
- Data visualisation and KPI reporting
- Translating data insights into actionable business recommendations